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Portable document file communication system

Abstract

A method for reconstructing a portable document file (PDF) for delivery via text messaging includes receiving, via a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device, user input identifying a portable document file, identifying a plurality of break points within the portable document file, generating a plurality of images for the portable document file using the plurality of break points each corresponding to one or more of a plurality of pages, generating a message parcel using the plurality of images and an archival link to a location storing the portable document file, and providing the message parcel as a text messaging service message to an endpoint device for presentation in a structured message UI on the endpoint device.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation application of co-pending U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/364,027, filed Mar. 25, 2019, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 62/650,072, filed on Mar. 29, 2018, each of which is incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

- (1) Text messaging has provided a way for people to conveniently interact with one another, carrying on conversations and conducting business using short electronic messages. The text messaging trend that began with T9 (Text on 9 keys), greatly accelerated with the advent of QWERTY keyboard cell phones and even further with touchscreen Smartphones. Traditional person-to-person text messaging channels do not support high-traffic throughput, and do not facilitate high-quality, high-integrity business communications. Current inefficiencies associated with administrating SMS messaging further restrict the ability of users to fully employ SMS messaging in business-to-business B2B and business-to-client B2C paradigms. This is due in part to traditional channels not providing an efficient means of integration with third-party services as well as the difficulty of utilizing SMS communications across disparate devices.
 - (2) This limits the ability of users to integrate, track, and analyze this increasingly vital form of communication. Similarly, the handing of business and personal documentation within the messaging ecosystem is substantially limited.
 - (3) PDF files are becoming increasingly central to business and personal document creation and management. Despite the near-ubiquity of both this format and smartphones generally, there has been little-to-no confluence of the two. Smartphone-based support for PDFs lags woefully behind that of the personal computer. Applications for accessing these vital documents on smartphones are scatter-shot in their implementation and work with varying degrees of success. Further, the current messaging ecosystem provides no standard way of delivering PDF files over text messaging.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) To easily identify the discussion of any particular element or act, the most significant digit or digits in a reference number refer to the figure number in which that element is first introduced.
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a messaging service environment **100**.
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates an embodiment of a messaging service environment **200**.
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates an embodiment of a PDF communication system **300**.

- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates a routine for operating a portable document file communication system in accordance with one embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates an embodiment of a sequence diagram **500**.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates a portable document file communication system **600** in accordance with one embodiment.
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates a user interface **700** in accordance with one embodiment.
- (9) FIG. 8 illustrates an embodiment of a digital apparatus **800** to implement components and process steps of the system described herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (10) “Endpoint” refers to client device and/or user interface acting as the recipient of a network resource rendered or utilized by a client device.
- (11) “Message parcel” refers to a collection of signals representing associated information, often including logic to define boundaries on what signals are and are not in the message parcel.
- (12) “Portable document file uploader” refers to logic or combination of logic for selecting stored data and communicating the stored data to a controlled memory data structure and/or to process. For example, in a GUI, an uploader allows a user to navigate through a file system to select at least one file to be communicated to a remote storage location or external process.
- (13) “Archival link” refers to a navigational link from one document to another, or from one portion (or component) of a document to another. Typically, a hyperlink is displayed as a highlighted word or phrase that can be selected by clicking on it using a mouse to jump to the associated document or documented portion.
- (14) “Archiver” refers to logic or combination of logic that combines a number of files together into one archive file, or a series of archive files, for easier transportation or storage. File archivers may employ lossless data compression in their archive formats to reduce the size of the archive. For example, a basic archiver takes a list of files and concatenate their contents sequentially into archives. The archive files need to store metadata, at least the names and lengths of the original files, if proper reconstruction is possible. More advanced archivers store additional metadata, such as the original timestamps, file attributes or access control lists.
- (15) “Multimedia message service (MMS)” refers to a store and forward messaging service that allows subscribers to exchange multimedia files as messages. MMS supports the transmission of various media types: text, picture, audio, video, or a combination of all four. The originator creates a Multimedia Message, for example by snapping a photo or recording a video with the phone camera, or by using images, videos, and sounds stored previously in the phone (or downloaded from a web site). If the recipient phone is not switched on or it has not been setup to receive MMS messages, the Multimedia Message will be stored in a special repository offered by the carrier. Multimedia Messaging Service is a descendant of SMS (Short Messaging Service). MMS extends text messaging to include longer text, graphics, photos, audio clips, video clips, or any combination of the above, within certain size limits. MMS is frequently used to send photos and videos from camera phones to other MMS phones or email accounts. Most camera phones have MMS, but many non-camera phones have it as well. Many newer MMS phones also support SMIL, which allows various parts of an MMS message to be arranged into a small multimedia “slideshow” to be viewed on another SMIL-capable MMS phone.
- (16) “Parser” refers to logic that divides an amalgamated input sequence or structure into multiple individual elements. Example hardware parsers are packet header parsers in network routers and switches. An example software or firmware parser is: `aFields=split(“val1, val2, val3”, “,”);` Another example of a software or firmware parser is: `readFromSensor gpsCoordinate;`
`x_pos=gpsCoordinate.x; y_pos=gpsCoordinate.y; z_pos=gpsCoordinate.z;` Other examples of parsers will be readily apparent to those of skill in the art, without undue experimentation.
- (17) A user may drop a PDF into a structured GUI, and the PDF may then be analyzed to determine break points within the PDF that determine where to partition the file into multiple individual

pages. The system may then partition the file into multiple pages and convert the pages into an image file format, for example JPEG or PNG. The portable document file analyzer may analyze the PDF files format and embedded markup to determine the pages, or may partition based on page content. For example, the system may analyze the PDF to determine where text and images are located on a given page and then partition the page into smaller images.

(18) The system may return images of the PDF to the user's phone, and may also return an archival link to the original PDF, which may be stored on a server and may together comprise a message parcel. The user may have the option to configure the message parcel to add, remove or re-order images to display and transmit a subset of images comprising a subset of the contents of the original PDF document. The user may make changes to the images themselves, adding their own markup, for example signing or drawing on an image. The system may copy the original PDF and edit the PDF copy to reflect changes made to the image set, the order of the images or the images themselves.

(19) The structured GUI may be a “compose window” which may generate the composition signal by a user interacting with the GUI. The composition signal may be triggered through an upload or attachment link, for example, a button, or may be a “drag-and-drop” interface. The message parcel may be configurable by the user after generation to comprise a subset of data in the message parcel. The contents of the message parcel may be able to be configured to display the contents in different orders.

(20) A method for operating a portable document file communication system involves receiving a composition control through a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device. The method may generate an attachment control to configure a portable document file uploader to upload a portable document file to a document transformation engine. A portable document file analyzer may then be operated to identify at least one break point within the portable document file. A portable document file splitter may then be configured with the at least one break point to generate at least one image from the portable document file and transmit the portable document file and the at least one image to an archiver. The archiver may then be operated to store the at least one image and the portable document file in a controlled memory data structure and generate an archival link. A multimedia message service (MMS) composer may be operated to generate a message parcel from the at least one image and the archival link. The structured message user interface may then be operated to communicate the message parcel as an MMS message to an endpoint.

(21) In some configurations, the composition control is generated in response to receiving the portable document file through the structured message UI.

(22) In some configurations, the at least one break point comprises at least one of a page group markup, an image object mark up, or combinations thereof.

(23) In some configurations, images of the at least one image in the message parcel are configurable through a message parcel configuration UI.

(24) In some configurations, the endpoint is a second device configured to receive the message parcel in the MMS message by way of a mobile carrier network.

(25) In some configurations, the at least one image is configured for transmission as an MMS message.

(26) A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, the computer-readable storage medium including instructions that when executed by a computer, cause the computer to receive a composition control through a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device. The computer may then generate an attachment control to configure a portable document file uploader to upload a portable document file to a document transformation engine. The computer may operate a portable document file analyzer to identify at least one break point within the portable document file. The computer may then configure a portable document file splitter with the at least one break point to generate at least one image from the portable document file and transmit the portable document file and the at least one image to an archiver. The computer may operate the

archiver to store the at least one image and the portable document file in a controlled memory data structure and generate an archival link. The computer may then operate a multimedia message service (MMS) composer to generate a message parcel from the at least one image and the archival link. Afterwards, the computer may operate the structured message user interface to communicate the message parcel as an MMS message to an endpoint.

(27) In some configurations, the composition control is generated in response to receiving the portable document file through the structured message UI.

(28) In some configurations, the at least one break point comprises at least one of a page group markup, an image object mark up, or combinations thereof.

(29) In some configurations, images of the at least one image in the message parcel are configurable through a message parcel configuration UI.

(30) In some configurations, the endpoint is a second device configured to receive the message parcel in the MMS message by way of a mobile carrier network.

(31) In some configurations, the at least one image is configured for transmission as an MMS message.

(32) A computing apparatus, the computing apparatus may include a processor and memory storing instructions that, when executed by the processor, configure the apparatus to receive a composition control through a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device. The apparatus may then generate an attachment control to configure a portable document file uploader to upload a portable document file to a document transformation engine. The apparatus may then operate a portable document file analyzer to identify at least one break point within the portable document file. The apparatus may configure a portable document file splitter with the at least one break point to generate at least one image from the portable document file and transmit the portable document file and the at least one image to an archiver. The apparatus may then operate the archiver to store the at least one image and the portable document file in a controlled memory data structure and generate an archival link. The apparatus may then operate a multimedia message service (MMS) composer to generate a message parcel from the at least one image and the archival link. The apparatus may then operate the structured message user interface to communicate the message parcel as an MMS message to an endpoint.

(33) In some configurations, the composition control is generated in response to receiving the portable document file through the structured message UI.

(34) In some configurations, the at least one break point comprises at least one of a page group markup, an image object mark up, or combinations thereof.

(35) In some configurations, images of the at least one image in the message parcel are configurable through a message parcel configuration UI.

(36) In some configurations, the endpoint is a second device configured to receive the message parcel in the MMS message by way of a mobile carrier network.

(37) In some configurations, the at least one image is configured for transmission as an MMS message.

(38) FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a messaging service environment **100**. The messaging service environment **100** comprises a mobile carrier network tower **102**, an SMS **104**, a client device **106**, an SMS gateway **108**, an SMS server **110**, an http server **112**, an http gateway **114**, a client device **116**, and a database **118**. The client device **106** transmits the SMS **104** to the mobile carrier network tower **102**. The SMS server **110** receives the SMS **104** from the mobile carrier network tower **102** via the SMS gateway **108**. The http server **112** receives the SMS **104** via the http gateway **114** and transmits the SMS **104** to the client device **116** and the database **118**.

(39) FIG. 2 illustrates a messaging service environment **200** in accordance with one embodiment. The messaging service environment **200** comprises a mobile carrier network **202**, a mobile carrier network **204**, a client device **206**, a client device **220**, an SMS server **208**, an SMS server **210**, a client device **212**, a server **214**, and a client device **218**. The client device **206** transmits an SMS

message to the SMS server **210** via the mobile carrier network **204**. The SMS server **210** transmits the SMS message to the server **214**. The server **214** transmits the SMS message to the client device **212**. The client device **218** transmits an SMS message to the server **216**, which transmits the SMS message to the SMS server **210** via the mobile carrier network **204**. The SMS server **210** transmits the SMS message to the SMS server **208** via the mobile carrier network **202**. The SMS server **208** transmits the SMS message to the client device **220**.

(40) FIG. 3 illustrates a PDF communication system **300** for communicating a message parcel **310** from a first device **338** to an endpoint (second device **308**). The PDF communication system **300** comprises a first device **338**, a document transformation engine **314**, and a second device **308**. The first device **338** comprises a structured message user interface **326** that receives a composition control **342** with a portable document file **302**. A portable document file uploader **318** communicates the portable document file **302** to a portable document file analyzer **332** of the document transformation engine **314** in response to an attachment control **340**. The portable document file analyzer **332** identifies at least one break point in the portable document file **302** and communicates the portable document file **302** and the at least one break point to a portable document file splitter **324**. The portable document file splitter **324** generates at least one image from the portable document file **302** as configured by the at least one break point. The at least one image (image **312** and image **320**) and the portable document file **302** are then communicated to an archiver **328** which stores the image **312** and the image **320** to a controlled memory data structure **306** along with the portable document file **302**. The archiver **328** generates an archival link **304** for the location of the portable document file **302** in the controlled memory data structure **306** and communicates the image **312**, the image **320**, and the archival link **304** to an MMS composer **334**. The MMS composer **334** generates a message parcel **310** from the archival link **304**, the image **320**, and the image **312**. The MMS composer **334** communicates the message parcel **310** to the structured message user interface **326** on the first device **338**. The message parcel **310** is configured as an MMS message by the MMS composer **334** and communicated to a second device **308** by way of a gateway **330** and a mobile carrier network **336** comprising an SMS server **316**. The contents of the message parcel **310** are displayed on the second device **308**. The second device **308** may also retrieve the portable document file **302** from the controlled memory data structure **306** by opening the archival link **322**.

(41) The PDF communication system **300** may be operated with the process outlined in FIG. 4.

(42) In FIG. 4, a method **400** for operating a PDF communication system involves receiving a composition control through a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device (block **402**). In block **404**, the method **400** generates an attachment control to configure a portable document file uploader to upload a portable document file to a document transformation engine. In block **406**, the method **400** operates a portable document file analyzer to identify at least one break point within the portable document file. In block **408**, the method **400** configures a portable document file splitter with the at least one break point to generate at least one image from the portable document file and transmit the portable document file and the at least one image to an archiver. In block **410**, the method **400** operates the archiver to store the at least one image and the portable document file in a controlled memory data structure and generate an archival link. In block **412**, the method **400** operates a multimedia message service (MMS) composer to generate a message parcel from the at least one image and the archival link. In block **414**, the method **400** operates the structured message user interface to communicate the message parcel as an MMS message to an endpoint.

(43) FIG. 5 illustrates a sequence diagram **500** for the operation of the PDF communication system **300**.

(44) In the sequence diagram **500**, the structured message user interface **326** receives a composition control, which may be a portable document file **302** and generates an attachment control to configure the portable document file uploader **318** to upload the portable document file **302** to the document transformation engine. The portable document file analyzer **332** detects that a portable

document file **302** has been uploaded and analyzes the portable document file **302** to extract at least one break point. The at least one break point configures the portable document file splitter **324** to generate image segments from the portable document file **302** in the form of an at least one image (image **312** and image **320**). The portable document file splitter **324** then communicates the original unmodified version of the portable document file **302** and image **312** and image **320**, to the archiver **328**. The archiver **328** stores the image **320**, the image **312** and the portable document file **302** in the controlled memory data structure **306** and generates an archival link **322** for accessing the stored images and the portable document file **302**. The MMS composer **334** generates a message parcel **310** from the archival link **322**, the image **312**, and the image **320** received from the archiver **328**. The structured message user interface **326** configures the message parcel **310** to transmit as an MMS message to an endpoint (second device **308**) by way of the gateway **330**, the SMS server **316** and the mobile carrier network **336**.

(45) FIG. **6** illustrates an embodiment of a portable document file communication system **600**. The system **600** comprises a first device **636** displaying a structured message user interface **604**. The structured message user interface **604** receives a portable document file **618** from a user through a drag and drop interaction **638**. The user may also open a file explorer and select the portable document file from an accessible storage location. The portable document file uploader **614** communicates the portable document file **618** to a PDF analyzer **606** with the document transformation engine **612**. The PDF analyzer **606** operates as a parser and identifies at least one break point **602** within the portable document file **618**. The PDF analyzer **606** may comprise a PDF decoder **608** and break point identifiers **610**. The PDF decoder **608** may be a hex decoder, a PDF reader, or a combination thereof that allows the PDF analyzer **606** to view mark up language of the portable document file **618** and or the constructed version of the portable document file **618** to identify break points. The break point identifiers **610** may be mark up language corresponding to pages and/or content in the portable document file **618**, for instance such as mark up language corresponding to a page group, and image objects. The break point identifiers **610** may also be a set of parameters corresponding to the display of the constructed portable document file **618**. The PDF analyzer **606** generates at least one break point **602** from the portable document file **618**. The at least one break point **602** may identify at least one of a page group **640** or an image object **642** within the portable document file **618**. The PDF analyzer **606** communicates the at least one break point **602** and the portable document file **618** to the portable document file splitter **616**. The portable document file splitter **616** utilizes the at least one break point **602** to generate at least one image **622** in the form of segments or extracted image content from the portable document file **618**. The at least one image **622** may comprise a page group image **628** and an image content object **630** from the page group **640** and the image object **642** respectively. The at least one image **622** and the portable document file **618** are then communicated to the archiver **624** to store in a controlled memory data structure **620**. The archiver **624** communicates an archival link **634** to the MMS composer **626** corresponding to the storage location of the at least one image **622** and the portable document file **618** in the controlled memory data structure **620**. The MMS composer **626** generates a message parcel **632** from the at least one image **622** and the archival link **634** which is then communicated to the structured message user interface **604**.

(46) The components of a portable document file (PDF) comprise syntax corresponding to objects, file structure, document structure, and content stream.

(47) Within a PDF document is a data structure comprising a small set of basic types of data objects. The PDF file structure determines how objects are stored in a PDF file, how they are accessed, and how they are updated. This structure is independent of the semantics of the objects. The PDF document structure specifies how the basic object types are used to represent components of a PDF document: pages, fonts, annotations, and so forth.

(48) A PDF content stream comprises a sequence of instructions describing the appearance of a page or other graphical entity. These instructions, while also represented as objects, are

conceptually distinct from the objects that represent the document structure and are described separately.

(49) At the most fundamental level, a PDF file is a sequence of bytes. These bytes can be grouped into tokens according to the syntax rules described in this sub-clause. One or more tokens are assembled to form higher level syntactic entities, principally objects, which are the basic data values from which a PDF document is constructed.

(50) A non-encrypted PDF can be entirely represented using byte values corresponding to the visible printable subset of the character set defined in ANSI X3.4-1986, plus white space characters. However, a PDF file is not restricted to the ASCII character set; it may contain arbitrary bytes, subject to the following considerations: The tokens that delimit objects and that describe the structure of a PDF file shall use the ASCII character set. In addition, all the reserved words and the names used as keys in PDF standard dictionaries and certain types of arrays shall be defined using the ASCII character set. The data values of strings and streams objects may be written either entirely using the ASCII character set or entirely in binary data. In actual practice, data that is naturally binary, such as sampled images, is usually represented in binary for compactness and efficiency. A PDF file containing binary data shall be transported as a binary file rather than as a text file to insure that all bytes of the file are faithfully preserved. File structure. The PDF file structure determines how objects are stored in a PDF file, how they are accessed, and how they are updated. This structure is independent of the semantics of the objects.

(51) The PDF document structure specifies how the basic object types are used to represent components of a PDF document: pages, fonts, annotations, and so forth. A PDF document can be regarded as a hierarchy of objects contained in the body section of a PDF file. At the root of the hierarchy is the document's catalog dictionary. The root of a document's object hierarchy is the catalog dictionary, located by means of the Root entry in the trailer of the PDF. The catalog contains references to other objects defining the document's contents, outline, article threads, named destinations, and other attributes. In addition, it contains information about how the document shall be displayed on the screen, such as whether its outline and thumbnail page images shall be displayed automatically and whether some location other than the first page shall be shown when the document is opened.

(52) A Page Group within a PDF correspond to document level mark up signifying the presentation of all elements corresponding to a page in both top-level groups and top-level objects that are not part of any group. This grouping of object is referred to as the page group. The page group may be treated in one of two distinctly different ways.

(53) Ordinarily, the page shall be imposed directly on an output medium, such as paper or a display screen. The page group shall be treated as an isolated group, whose results shall then be composited with a backdrop color appropriate for the medium. The backdrop may be nominally white, although varying according to the actual properties of the medium. However, some conforming readers may choose to provide a different backdrop, such as a checker board or grid to aid in visualizing the effects of transparency in the artwork.

(54) Another way that a page group may be treated is by treating a “page” of a PDF file a graphics object to be used as an element of a page of some other document.

(55) A PDF content stream contains a sequence of instructions describing the appearance of a page or other graphical entity. These instructions, while also represented as objects, are conceptually distinct from the objects that represent the document structure and are described separately.

(56) Content streams are the primary means for describing the appearance of pages and other graphical elements. A content stream depends on information contained in an associated resource dictionary; in combination, these two objects form a self-contained entity.

(57) A content stream is a PDF stream object whose data includes of a sequence of instructions describing the graphical elements to be painted on a page. The instructions shall be represented in the form of PDF objects, using the same object syntax as in the rest of the PDF document.

However, whereas the document as a whole is a static, random-access data structure, the objects in the content stream shall be interpreted and acted upon sequentially.

(58) Each page of a document shall be represented by one or more content streams. Content streams shall also be used to package sequences of instructions as self-contained graphical elements, such as forms, patterns, certain fonts, and annotation appearances.

(59) A content stream, after decoding with any specified filters, shall be interpreted according to the PDF syntax rules. This may comprise PDF objects denoting operands and operators. The operands needed by an operator shall precede it in the stream.

(60) An operand is a direct object belonging to any of the basic PDF data types except a stream. Dictionaries shall be permitted as operands only by certain specific operators. Indirect objects and object references shall not be permitted at all.

(61) The data in a content stream shall be interpreted as a sequence of operators and their operands, expressed as basic data objects according to standard PDF syntax. A content stream can describe the appearance of a page, or it can be treated as a graphical element in certain other contexts.

(62) The operands and operators shall be written sequentially using postfix notation. Although this notation resembles the sequential execution model of the PostScript language, a PDF content stream is not a program to be interpreted; rather, it is a static description of a sequence of graphics objects. There are specific rules, described below, for writing the operands and operators that describe a graphics object.

(63) A PDF provides five types of graphics objects: a path object, a text object, an external object, an inline object, and a shading object.

(64) A path object is an arbitrary shape made up of straight lines, rectangles, and cubic Bézier curves. A path may intersect itself and may have disconnected sections and holes. A path object ends with one or more painting operators that specify whether the path shall be stroked, filled, used as a clipping boundary, or some combination of these operations.

(65) A text object includes one or more character strings that identify sequences of glyphs to be painted. Like a path, text can be stroked, filled, or used as a clipping boundary.

(66) An external object (XObject) is an object defined outside the content stream and referenced as a named resource “Resource Dictionaries”. The interpretation of an XObject depends on its type. An image XObject defines a rectangular array of color samples to be painted; a form XObject is an entire content stream to be treated as a single graphics object. Specialized types of form XObjects shall be used to import content from one PDF file into another and to group graphical elements together as a unit for various purposes (group XObjects). In particular, the latter are used to define transparency groups for use in the transparent imaging model. There is also a PostScript XObject that may appear in some existing PDF files.

(67) An inline image object uses a special syntax to express the data for a small image directly within the content stream.

(68) A shading object describes a geometric shape whose color is an arbitrary function of position within the shape. (A shading can also be treated as a color when painting other graphics objects; it is not considered to be a separate graphics object in that case.)

(69) An image is defined by a sequence of samples obtained by scanning the image array in row or column order. Each sample in the array includes as many color components as are needed for the color space in which they are specified—for example, one component for DeviceGray, three for DeviceRGB, four for DeviceCMYK, or whatever number is required by a particular DeviceN space.

(70) A PDF's painting operators include general facilities for dealing with sampled images. A sampled image (or just image for short) is a rectangular array of sample values, each representing a color. The image may approximate the appearance of some natural scene obtained through an input scanner or a video camera, or it may be generated synthetically.

(71) A PDF provides two means for specifying images as an external object or as an inline object.

(72) An image XObject is a stream object whose dictionary specifies attributes of the image and whose data contains the image samples. Like all external objects, it is painted on the page by invoking the Do operator in a content stream “External Objects”. Image XObjects have other uses as well, such as for alternate images “Alternate Images”, image masks, and thumbnail images. In inline image is a small image that is completely defined—both attributes and data—directly inline within a content stream. The kinds of images that can be represented in this way are limited;

(73) The properties of an image such as resolution, orientation, scanning order, and so forth, are entirely independent of the characteristics of the raster output device on which the image is to be rendered. A conforming reader usually renders images by a sampling technique that attempts to approximate the color values of the source as accurately as possible. The actual accuracy achieved depends on the resolution and other properties of the output device.

(74) FIG. 7 illustrates an embodiment of a user interface **700** comprising the structured message user interface **702** after receiving the message parcel **714** from the MMS composer **716**. In the user interface **700** the message parcel **714** is configurable through a message parcel configuration UI **704** in the structured message user interface **702**. The message parcel **714** comprises the at least one image **720** and an archival link **712**. The at least one image **720** may include page images **706** and content object images **710** from the portable document file. The individual images of the content object images **710** and the page images **706** may be rearranged or removed from message parcel **714** as desired by the user. A user may remove unwanted images from the message parcel **714** by selecting a deselector **708**. The message parcel configuration UI **704** additionally includes an input field for adding a destination address **718** for a recipient. The destination address **718** may include a recipient's phone number, carrier network address, etc. When the user completes configuring the message parcel **714**, the may send the message parcel **714** by hitting the send button **722**. Alternatively, the user may cancel the message parcel **714** by hitting the cancel button **724**.

(75) FIG. 8 illustrates an embodiment of a digital apparatus **800** to implement components and process steps of the system described herein.

(76) Input devices **804** comprise transducers that convert physical phenomenon into machine internal signals, typically electrical, optical or magnetic signals. Signals may also be wireless in the form of electromagnetic radiation in the radio frequency (RF) range but also potentially in the infrared or optical range. Examples of input devices **804** are keyboards which respond to touch or physical pressure from an object or proximity of an object to a surface, mice which respond to motion through space or across a plane, microphones which convert vibrations in the medium (typically air) into device signals, scanners which convert optical patterns on two or three dimensional objects into device signals. The signals from the input devices **804** are provided via various machine signal conductors (e.g., busses or network interfaces) and circuits to memory **806**.

(77) The memory **806** is typically what is known as a first or second level memory device, providing for storage (via configuration of matter or states of matter) of signals received from the input devices **804**, instructions and information for controlling operation of the CPU **802**, and signals from storage devices **810**.

(78) The memory **806** and/or the storage devices **810** may store computer-executable instructions and thus forming logic **814** that when applied to and executed by the CPU **802** implement embodiments of the processes disclosed herein. In some embodiments, memory **806** and the storage devices **810** may include logic corresponding to the document transformation engine **314**, the portable document file uploader **318**, the portable document file splitter **324**, the structured message user interface **326**, the archiver **328**, the portable document file analyzer **332**, the MMS composer **334**, and the method **400**.

(79) Information stored in the memory **806** is typically directly accessible to the CPU **802** of the device. Signals input to the device cause the reconfiguration of the internal material/energy state of the memory **806**, creating in essence a new machine configuration, influencing the behavior of the

digital apparatus **800** by affecting the behavior of the CPU **802** with control signals (instructions) and data provided in conjunction with the control signals.

(80) Second or third level storage devices **810** may provide a slower but higher capacity machine memory capability. Examples of storage devices **810** are hard disks, optical disks, large capacity flash memories or other non-volatile memory technologies, and magnetic memories.

(81) The CPU **802** may cause the configuration of the memory **806** to be altered by signals in storage devices **810**. In other words, the CPU **802** may cause data and instructions to be read from storage devices **810** in the memory **806** from which may then influence the operations of CPU **802** as instructions and data signals, and from which it may also be provided to the output devices **808**. The CPU **802** may alter the content of the memory **806** by signaling to a machine interface of memory **806** to alter the internal configuration, and then converted signals to the storage devices **810** to alter its material internal configuration. In other words, data and instructions may be backed up from memory **806**, which is often volatile, to storage devices **810**, which are often non-volatile.

(82) Output devices **808** are transducers which convert signals received from the memory **806** into physical phenomenon such as vibrations in the air, or patterns of light on a machine display, or vibrations (i.e., haptic devices) or patterns of ink or other materials (i.e., printers and 3-D printers).

(83) The network interface **812** receives signals from the memory **806** and converts them into electrical, optical, or wireless signals to other machines, typically via a machine network. The network interface **812** also receives signals from the machine network and converts them into electrical, optical, or wireless signals to the memory **806**.

(84) Terms used herein should be accorded their ordinary meaning in the relevant arts, or the meaning indicated by their use in context, but if an express definition is provided, that meaning controls.

(85) "Circuitry" in this context refers to electrical circuitry having at least one discrete electrical circuit, electrical circuitry having at least one integrated circuit, electrical circuitry having at least one application specific integrated circuit, circuitry forming a general purpose computing device configured by a computer program (e.g., a general purpose computer configured by a computer program which at least partially carries out processes or devices described herein, or a microprocessor configured by a computer program which at least partially carries out processes or devices described herein), circuitry forming a memory device (e.g., forms of random access memory), or circuitry forming a communications device (e.g., a modem, communications switch, or optical-electrical equipment).

(86) "Firmware" in this context refers to software logic embodied as processor-executable instructions stored in read-only memories or media.

(87) "Hardware" in this context refers to logic embodied as analog or digital circuitry.

(88) "Logic" in this context refers to machine memory circuits, non transitory machine readable media, and/or circuitry which by way of its material and/or material-energy configuration comprises control and/or procedural signals, and/or settings and values (such as resistance, impedance, capacitance, inductance, current/voltage ratings, etc.), that may be applied to influence the operation of a device. Magnetic media, electronic circuits, electrical and optical memory (both volatile and nonvolatile), and firmware are examples of logic. Logic specifically excludes pure signals or software per se (however does not exclude machine memories comprising software and thereby forming configurations of matter).

(89) "Programmable device" in this context refers to an integrated circuit designed to be configured and/or reconfigured after manufacturing. The term "programmable processor" is another name for a programmable device herein. Programmable devices may include programmable processors, such as field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), configurable hardware logic (CHL), and/or any other type programmable devices. Configuration of the programmable device is generally specified using a computer code or data such as a hardware description language (HDL), such as for example Verilog, VHDL, or the like. A programmable device may include an array of programmable logic

blocks and a hierarchy of reconfigurable interconnects that allow the programmable logic blocks to be coupled to each other according to the descriptions in the HDL code. Each of the programmable logic blocks may be configured to perform complex combinational functions, or merely simple logic gates, such as AND, and XOR logic blocks. In most FPGAs, logic blocks also include memory elements, which may be simple latches, flip-flops, hereinafter also referred to as “flops,” or more complex blocks of memory. Depending on the length of the interconnections between different logic blocks, signals may arrive at input terminals of the logic blocks at different times. (90) “Software” in this context refers to logic implemented as processor-executable instructions in a machine memory (e.g. read/write volatile or nonvolatile memory or media).

(91) Herein, references to “one embodiment” or “an embodiment” do not necessarily refer to the same embodiment, although they may. Unless the context clearly requires otherwise, throughout the description and the claims, the words “comprise,” “comprising,” and the like are to be construed in an inclusive sense as opposed to an exclusive or exhaustive sense; that is to say, in the sense of “including, but not limited to.” Words using the singular or plural number also include the plural or singular number respectively, unless expressly limited to a single one or multiple ones. Additionally, the words “herein,” “above,” “below” and words of similar import, when used in this application, refer to this application as a whole and not to any particular portions of this application. When the claims use the word “or” in reference to a list of two or more items, that word covers all of the following interpretations of the word: any of the items in the list, all of the items in the list and any combination of the items in the list, unless expressly limited to one or the other. Any terms not expressly defined herein have their conventional meaning as commonly understood by those having skill in the relevant art(s).

(92) Various logic functional operations described herein may be implemented in logic that is referred to using a noun or noun phrase reflecting said operation or function. For example, an association operation may be carried out by an “associator” or “correlator”. Likewise, switching may be carried out by a “switch”, selection by a “selector”, and so on.

(93) Those skilled in the art will recognize that it is common within the art to describe devices or processes in the fashion set forth herein, and thereafter use standard engineering practices to integrate such described devices or processes into larger systems. At least a portion of the devices or processes described herein can be integrated into a network processing system via a reasonable amount of experimentation. Various embodiments are described herein and presented by way of example and not limitation.

(94) Those having skill in the art will appreciate that there are various logic implementations by which processes and/or systems described herein can be affected (e.g., hardware, software, or firmware), and that the preferred vehicle will vary with the context in which the processes are deployed. If an implementer determines that speed and accuracy are paramount, the implementer may opt for a hardware or firmware implementation; alternatively, if flexibility is paramount, the implementer may opt for a solely software implementation; or, yet again alternatively, the implementer may opt for some combination of hardware, software, or firmware. Hence, there are numerous possible implementations by which the processes described herein may be effected, none of which is inherently superior to the other in that any vehicle to be utilized is a choice dependent upon the context in which the implementation will be deployed and the specific concerns (e.g., speed, flexibility, or predictability) of the implementer, any of which may vary. Those skilled in the art will recognize that optical aspects of implementations may involve optically-oriented hardware, software, and or firmware.

(95) Those skilled in the art will appreciate that logic may be distributed throughout one or more devices, and/or may be comprised of combinations memory, media, processing circuits and controllers, other circuits, and so on. Therefore, in the interest of clarity and correctness logic may not always be distinctly illustrated in drawings of devices and systems, although it is inherently present therein. The techniques and procedures described herein may be implemented via logic

distributed in one or more computing devices. The particular distribution and choice of logic will vary according to implementation.

(96) The foregoing detailed description has set forth various embodiments of the devices or processes via the use of block diagrams, flowcharts, or examples. Insofar as such block diagrams, flowcharts, or examples contain one or more functions or operations, it will be understood as notorious by those within the art that each function or operation within such block diagrams, flowcharts, or examples can be implemented, individually or collectively, by a wide range of hardware, software, firmware, or virtually any combination thereof. Portions of the subject matter described herein may be implemented via Application Specific Integrated Circuits (ASICs), Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs), digital signal processors (DSPs), or other integrated formats. However, those skilled in the art will recognize that some aspects of the embodiments disclosed herein, in whole or in part, can be equivalently implemented in standard integrated circuits, as one or more computer programs running on one or more processing devices (e.g., as one or more programs running on one or more computer systems), as one or more programs running on one or more processors (e.g., as one or more programs running on one or more microprocessors), as firmware, or as virtually any combination thereof, and that designing the circuitry or writing the code for the software or firmware would be well within the skill of one of skill in the art in light of this disclosure. In addition, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the mechanisms of the subject matter described herein are capable of being distributed as a program product in a variety of forms, and that an illustrative embodiment of the subject matter described herein applies equally regardless of the particular type of signal bearing media used to actually carry out the distribution. Examples of a signal bearing media include, but are not limited to, the following: recordable type media such as floppy disks, hard disk drives, CD ROMs, digital tape, flash drives, SD cards, solid state fixed or removable storage, and computer memory.

(97) In a general sense, those skilled in the art will recognize that the various aspects described herein which can be implemented, individually or collectively, by a wide range of hardware, software, firmware, or any combination thereof can be viewed as being composed of various types of circuitry.

(98) It will be appreciated that numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the example embodiments described herein. However, it will be understood by those of ordinary skill in the art that the embodiments described herein may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known methods, procedures and components have not been described in detail so as not to obscure the embodiments described herein. Furthermore, this description and the drawings are not to be considered as limiting the scope of the embodiments described herein in any way, but rather as merely describing the implementation of the various embodiments described herein.

(99) It should be noted that terms of degree such as “substantially”, “about” and “approximately” when used herein mean a reasonable amount of deviation of the modified term such that the end result is not significantly changed. These terms of degree should be construed as including a deviation of the modified term if this deviation would not negate the meaning of the term it modifies.

(100) In addition, as used herein, the wording “and/or” is intended to represent an inclusive-or. That is, “X and/or Y” is intended to mean X or Y or both, for example. As a further example, “X, Y, and/or Z” is intended to mean X or Y or Z or any combination thereof.

(101) It should be noted that the term “coupled” used herein indicates that two elements can be directly coupled to one another or coupled to one another through one or more intermediate elements.

(102) The embodiments of the systems and methods described herein may be implemented in hardware or software, or a combination of both. These embodiments may be implemented in computer programs executing on programmable computers, each computer including at least one

processor, a data storage system (including volatile memory or non-volatile memory or other data storage elements or a combination thereof), and at least one communication interface. For example and without limitation, the programmable computers may be a server, network appliance, embedded device, computer expansion module, a personal computer, laptop, a wireless device or any other computing device capable of being configured to carry out the methods described herein. (103) Each program may be implemented in a high level procedural or object oriented programming and/or scripting language, or both, to communicate with a computer system. However, the programs may be implemented in assembly or machine language, if desired. In any case, the language may be a compiled or interpreted language. Each such computer program may be stored on a storage media or a device (e.g. ROM, magnetic disk, optical disc) readable by a general or special purpose programmable computer, for configuring and operating the computer when the storage media or device is read by the computer to perform the procedures described herein. Embodiments of the system may also be considered to be implemented as a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, configured with a computer program, where the storage medium so configured causes a computer to operate in a specific and predefined manner to perform the functions described herein. (104) Furthermore, the system, processes and methods of the described embodiments are capable of being distributed in a computer program product comprising a computer readable medium that bears computer usable instructions for one or more processors. The medium may be provided in various forms, including one or more diskettes, compact disks, tapes, chips, wireline transmissions, satellite transmissions, internet transmission or downloadings, magnetic and electronic storage media, digital and analog signals, and the like. The computer useable instructions may also be in various forms, including compiled and non-compiled code. (105) Various embodiments have been described herein by way of example only. Various modification and variations may be made to these example embodiments without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention, which is limited only by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A method comprising: receiving, via a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device, user input identifying an initial portable document file; identifying a plurality of break points within the initial portable document file, each of the plurality of break points corresponding to one or more of a plurality of pages in the initial portable document file; generating, from the portable document file, a plurality of images using the plurality of break points each corresponding to the one or more of the plurality of pages; generating a message parcel including the plurality of images each corresponding to a respective page of the plurality of pages of the initial portable document file, and an archival link to a location storing the initial portable document file from which the plurality of images was generated; and providing, as a text messaging service message, the message parcel that includes the plurality of images each corresponding to the respective page of the plurality of pages of the initial portable document file, and the archival link to the location storing the initial portable document file from which the plurality of images was generated, wherein the message parcel is provided as the text messaging service message to an endpoint device for presentation in a structured message UI on the endpoint device.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least one break point is identified within the initial portable document file using one or more of a hex decoder or a portable document file reader.
3. The method of claim 1, further comprising transmitting the initial portable document file and the plurality of images to an external archiver system for generating the archival link.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the text messaging service message comprises at least one of a multimedia message service (MMS) message or a short messaging service (SMS) message.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least one break point comprises one or more of a page

group markup or an image object mark up.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of images in the message parcel is configurable via a message parcel configuration UI.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein, the endpoint device is a second device configured to receive the message parcel in the text messaging service message via a mobile carrier network.

8. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium including instructions that when executed by a processor, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: receiving, via a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device, user input identifying an initial portable document file; identifying a plurality of break points within the initial portable document file, each of the plurality of break points corresponding to one or more of a plurality of pages in the initial portable document file; generating, from the portable document file, a plurality of images using the plurality of break points each corresponding to the one or more of the plurality of pages; generating a message parcel including the plurality of images each corresponding to a respective page of the plurality of pages of the initial portable document file, and an archival link to a location storing the initial portable document file from which the plurality of images was generated; and providing, as a text messaging service message, the message parcel that includes the plurality of images each corresponding to the respective page of the plurality of pages of the initial portable document file, and the archival link to the location storing the initial portable document file from which the plurality of images was generated, wherein the message parcel is provided as the text messaging service message to an endpoint device for presentation in a structured message UI on the endpoint device.

9. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the at least one break point is identified within the initial portable document file using one or more of a hex decoder or a portable document file reader.

10. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, the operations further comprising transmitting the initial portable document file and the plurality of images to an external archiver system for generating the archival link.

11. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the text messaging service message comprises at least one of a multimedia message service (MMS) message or a short messaging service (SMS) message.

12. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the at least one break point comprises one or more of a page group markup or an image object mark up.

13. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the plurality of images in the message parcel is configurable via a message parcel configuration UI.

14. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein, the endpoint device is a second device configured to receive the message parcel in the text messaging service message via a mobile carrier network.

15. A system comprising: a memory; and a processor, coupled to the memory, to perform operations comprising: receiving, via a structured message user interface (UI) on a first device, user input identifying an initial portable document file; identifying a plurality of break points within the initial portable document file, each of the plurality of break points corresponding to one or more of a plurality of pages in the initial portable document file; generating, from the portable document file, a plurality of images using the plurality of break points each corresponding to the one or more of the plurality of pages; generating a message parcel including the plurality of images each corresponding to a respective page of the plurality of pages of the initial portable document file, and an archival link to a location storing the initial portable document file from which the plurality of images was generated; and providing, as a text messaging service message, the message parcel that includes the plurality of images each corresponding to the respective page of the plurality of pages of the initial portable document file, and the archival link to the location storing the initial portable document file from which the plurality of images was generated, wherein the message

parcel is provided as the text messaging service message to an endpoint device for presentation in a structured message UI on the endpoint device.

16. The system of claim 15, wherein the at least one break point is identified within the initial portable document file using one or more of a hex decoder or a portable document file reader.

17. The system of claim 15, the operations further comprising transmitting the initial portable document file and the plurality of images to an external archiver system for generating the archival link.

18. The system of claim 15, wherein the text messaging service message comprises at least one of a multimedia message service (MMS) message or a short messaging service (SMS) message.

19. The system of claim 15, wherein the at least one break point comprises one or more of a page group markup or an image object mark up.

20. The system of claim 15, wherein the endpoint device is a second device configured to receive the message parcel in the text messaging service message via a mobile carrier network.
